

UB Math

Black History Month

Great Black Mathematicians

- ▶ There are many great black mathematicians despite the many historical challenges.
- ▶ But there have been and are many obstacles for many African Americans to become mathematicians.
- ▶ Less than 1% of mathematicians are black.
- ▶ Prior to 1970, black mathematicians were not allowed to participate in the mathematical community.



David Blackwell

- ▶ Earned his Ph.D. at the age of 22 from University of Illinois in 1941!



Figure: David Blackwell and his book

- ▶ Researched games theory and statistics
- ▶ First African American named to the National Academy of Sciences
- ▶ Published 80 mathematical papers!

J. Ernest Wilkins

- ▶ Started college at age 13!
- ▶ Earned his Ph.D at the age of 19 from the University of Chicago.
- ▶ Published more than 100 papers in Mathematics, Physics, and Engineering.
- ▶ Research in calculus of variations.



Figure: J. Ernest Wilkins ◀ ◻ ▶ ◀ ◻ ▶ ◀ ≡ ▶ ◀ ≡ ▶ ≡ 🔍 ↺

Katherine Adebola Okikiolu



Figure: Katherine Adebola Okikiolu

- ▶ Born 1965 -present.
- ▶ Professor of Mathematics University of California at San Diego
- ▶ Researches geometric analysis

Clifford Johnson

- ▶ Professor Department of Physics and Astronomy, University of Southern California
- ▶ Researches theoretical physics.
- ▶ Wrote graphic novel called Dialogues.

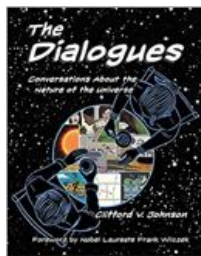


Figure: Venn Diagrams of animals.